

CSharPN

A Code-First Framework for Coloured Petri Net Modelling
with C# as Inscription Language

Simon Tjell

Independent Researcher · simon@simplesystemer.dk

PNSE'26 · Petri Nets and Software Engineering · June 2026

The context

A personal note on where this work comes from.

The context

A personal note on where this work comes from.

- Fell for **Coloured Petri Nets** during my MSc and PhD in the CPN group at **University of Aarhus**

The context

A personal note on where this work comes from.

- Fell for **Coloured Petri Nets** during my MSc and PhD in the CPN group at **University of Aarhus**
- Left academia for **industry** — **17 years ago**

The context

A personal note on where this work comes from.

- Fell for **Coloured Petri Nets** during my MSc and PhD in the CPN group at **University of Aarhus**
- Left academia for **industry** — **17 years ago**
- Systems keep growing more complex: microservices on Kubernetes, with authentication, databases, caches

The context

A personal note on where this work comes from.

- Fell for **Coloured Petri Nets** during my MSc and PhD in the CPN group at **University of Aarhus**
- Left academia for **industry** — **17 years ago**
- Systems keep growing more complex: microservices on Kubernetes, with authentication, databases, caches
- The need for **modelling** is very much present — but not always recognised by practitioners

The context

A personal note on where this work comes from.

- Fell for **Coloured Petri Nets** during my MSc and PhD in the CPN group at **University of Aarhus**
- Left academia for **industry** — **17 years ago**
- Systems keep growing more complex: microservices on Kubernetes, with authentication, databases, caches
- The need for **modelling** is very much present — but not always recognised by practitioners
- Never forgot the old romance: I kept looking for problems that fit the tool, and kept reaching for CPNs

The context

A personal note on where this work comes from.

- Fell for **Coloured Petri Nets** during my MSc and PhD in the CPN group at **University of Aarhus**
- Left academia for **industry** — **17 years ago**
- Systems keep growing more complex: microservices on Kubernetes, with authentication, databases, caches
- The need for **modelling** is very much present — but not always recognised by practitioners
- Never forgot the old romance: I kept looking for problems that fit the tool, and kept reaching for CPNs

To a younger generation of developers, Coloured Petri Nets look increasingly exotic.

The problem

A persistent **gap** between modelling and implementation:

The problem

A persistent **gap** between modelling and implementation:

- The **modelling tool** (e.g., CPN Tools) sits apart from the **development tool** — the IDE (e.g., Visual Studio Code)

The problem

A persistent **gap** between modelling and implementation:

- The **modelling tool** (e.g., CPN Tools) sits apart from the **development tool** — the IDE (e.g., Visual Studio Code)
- The **modelling language** (e.g. Standard ML) is not the **implementation language** (e.g., C#)

The problem

A persistent **gap** between modelling and implementation:

- The **modelling tool** (e.g., CPN Tools) sits apart from the **development tool** — the IDE (e.g., Visual Studio Code)
- The **modelling language** (e.g. Standard ML) is not the **implementation language** (e.g., C#)
- Model and implementation live in **two different worlds**, and drift apart over time

The problem

A persistent **gap** between modelling and implementation:

- The **modelling tool** (e.g., CPN Tools) sits apart from the **development tool** — the IDE (e.g., Visual Studio Code)
- The **modelling language** (e.g. Standard ML) is not the **implementation language** (e.g., C#)
- Model and implementation live in **two different worlds**, and drift apart over time
- Code generation from model has often been attempted - but has it's own problems

The problem

A persistent **gap** between modelling and implementation:

- The **modelling tool** (e.g., CPN Tools) sits apart from the **development tool** — the IDE (e.g., Visual Studio Code)
- The **modelling language** (e.g. Standard ML) is not the **implementation language** (e.g., C#)
- Model and implementation live in **two different worlds**, and drift apart over time
- Code generation from model has often been attempted - but has it's own problems

Underneath it, the older gap between **academia and industry**.

A possible solution

CSharPN — a framework for working with Coloured Petri Nets in C#, with a VS Code extension for visualising and executing models.

A possible solution

CSharPN — a framework for working with Coloured Petri Nets in C#, with a VS Code extension for visualising and executing models.

- The model is itself a **program in the target language**

A possible solution

CSharPN — a framework for working with Coloured Petri Nets in C#, with a VS Code extension for visualising and executing models.

- The model is itself a **program in the target language**
- Developers stay in their **IDE** (VS Code)

A possible solution

CSharPN — a framework for working with Coloured Petri Nets in C#, with a VS Code extension for visualising and executing models.

- The model is itself a **program in the target language**
- Developers stay in their **IDE** (VS Code)
- Developers work in their **day-to-day language** (C#)

A possible solution

CSharPN — a framework for working with Coloured Petri Nets in C#, with a VS Code extension for visualising and executing models.

- The model is itself a **program in the target language**
- Developers stay in their **IDE** (VS Code)
- Developers work in their **day-to-day language** (C#)
- The **model is the implementation**

A possible solution

CSharPN — a framework for working with Coloured Petri Nets in C#, with a VS Code extension for visualising and executing models.

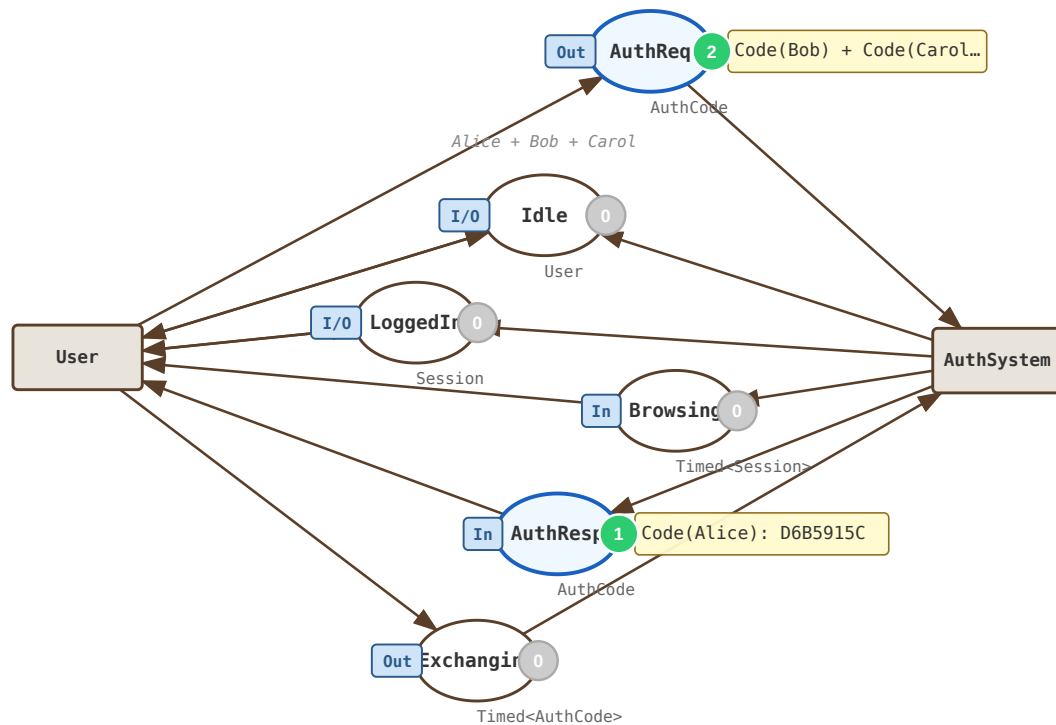
- The model is itself a **program in the target language**
- Developers stay in their **IDE** (VS Code)
- Developers work in their **day-to-day language** (C#)
- The **model is the implementation**

Simulation-based development — with concurrency, resource sharing and timing modelled *explicitly*.

Running example: OAuth2 authoriz

Exercises all three features:

Top page: shared places link the two substitution transitions.

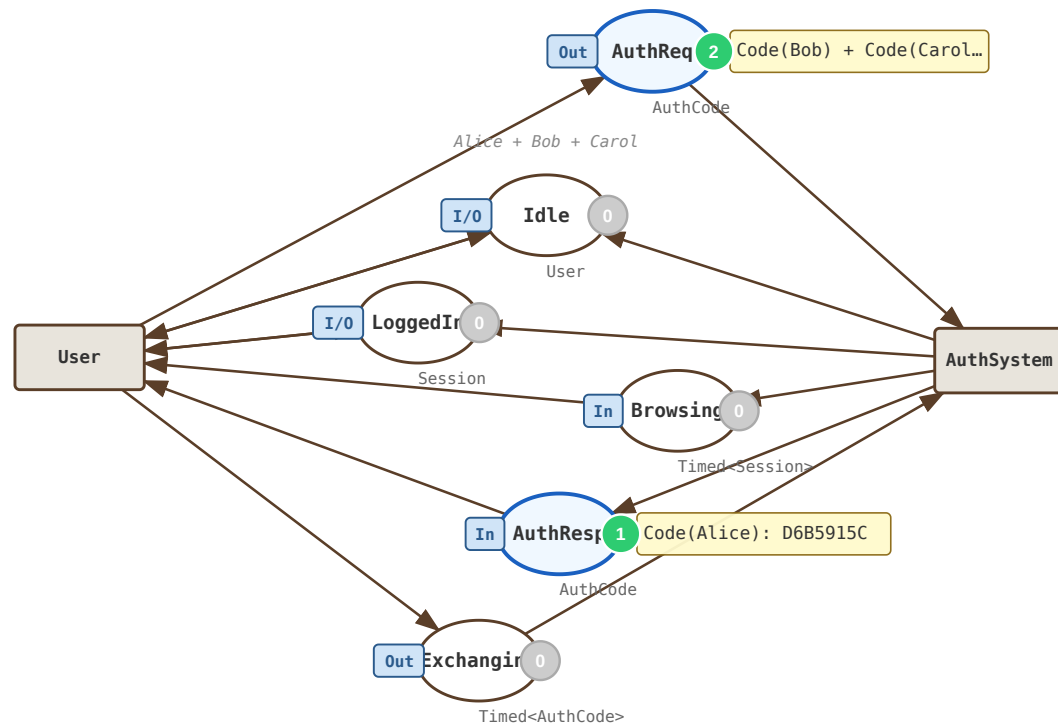


Running example: OAuth2 authoriz

Exercises all three features:

- Three concurrent users

Top page: shared places link the two substitution transitions.

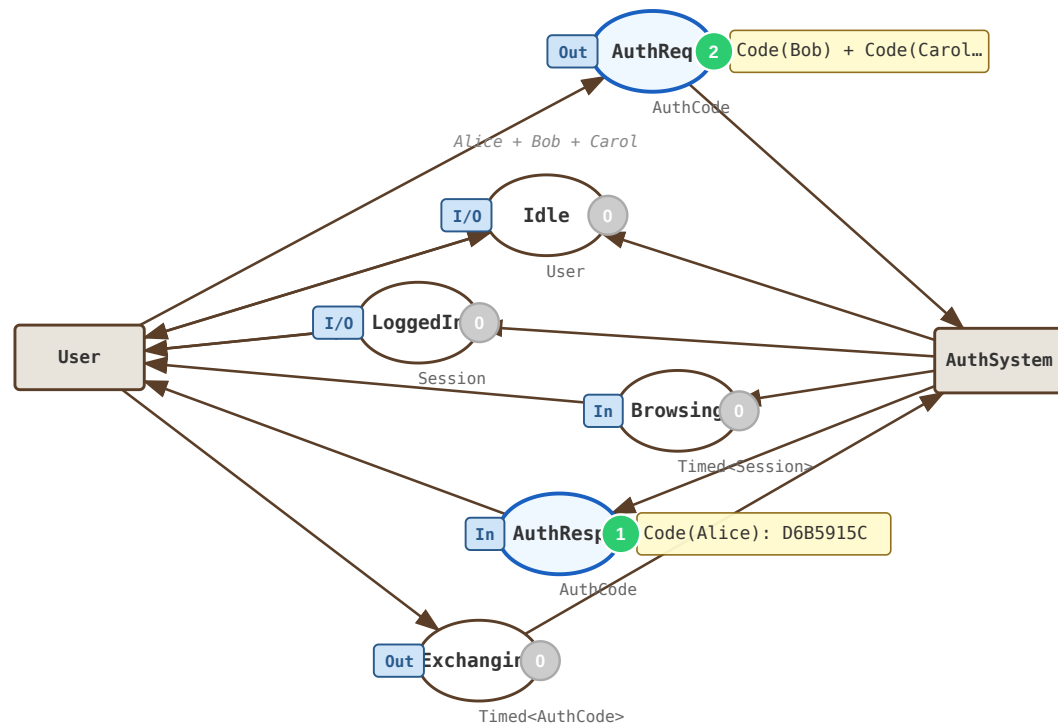


Running example: OAuth2 authoriz

Exercises all three features:

- Three concurrent users
- Shared places as channels

Top page: shared places link the two substitution transitions.

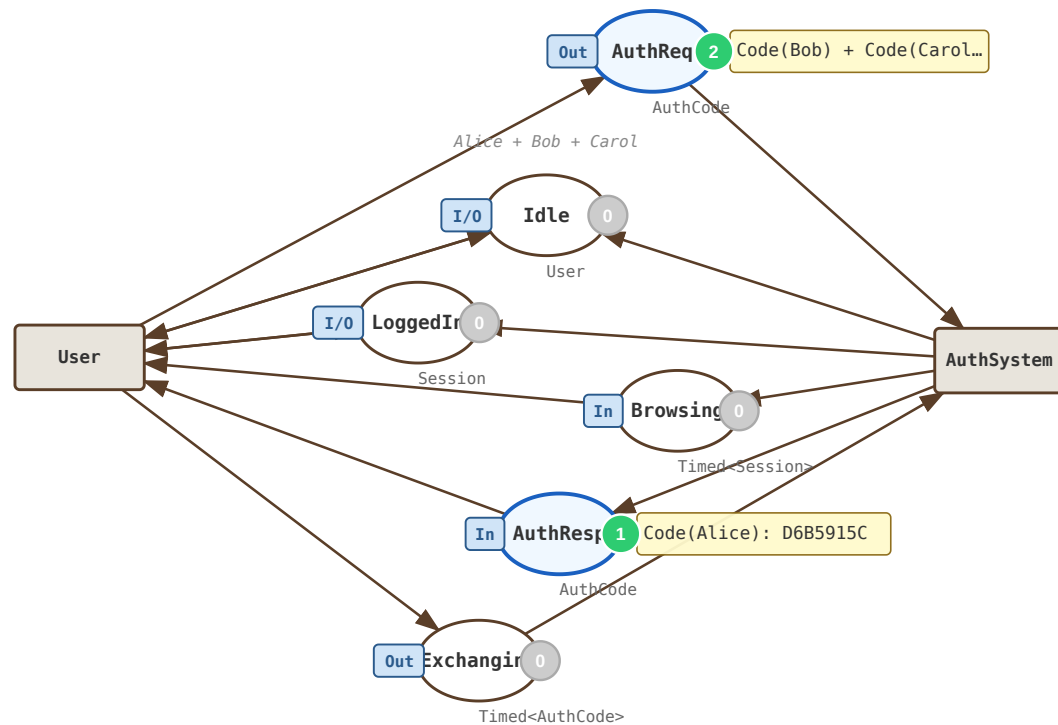


Running example: OAuth2 authoriz

Exercises all three features:

- Three concurrent users
- Shared places as channels
- Timed auth, exchange, expiry

Top page: shared places link the two substitution transitions.

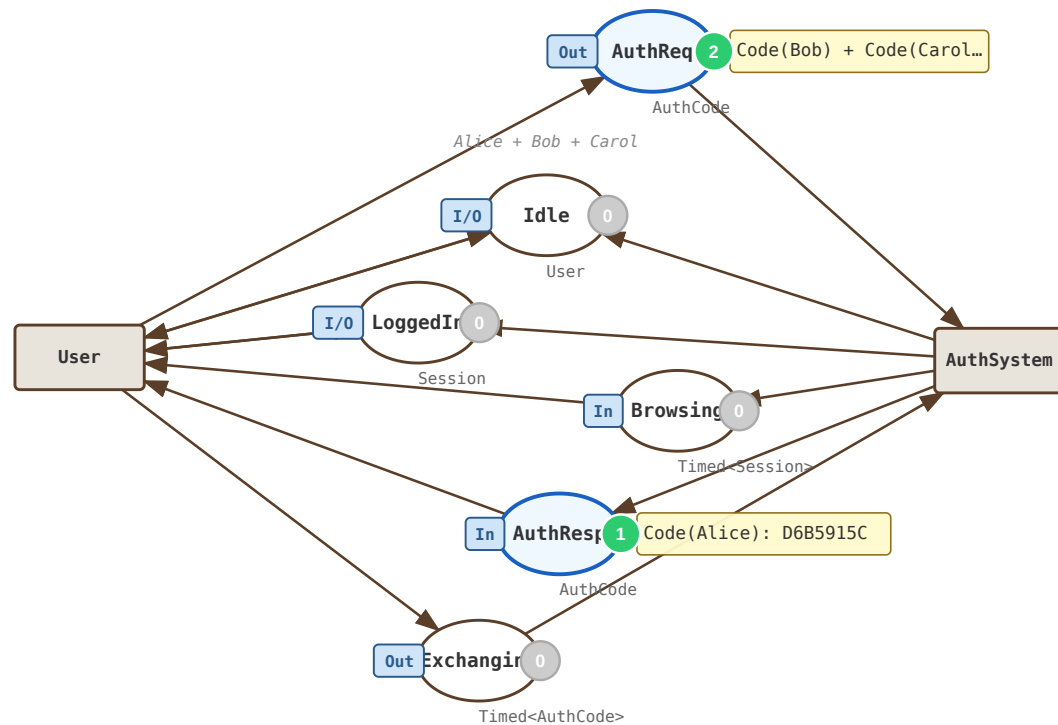


Running example: OAuth2 authori

Exercises all three features:

- Three concurrent users
- Shared places as channels
- Timed auth, exchange, expiry
- Two sub-pages: User & AuthSystem

Top page: shared places link the two substitution transitions.



Colour sets are just C# types

Any `notnull, IEquatable<T>` type works — primitives, enums, records, classes.

```
public record User(int Id, string Name) {  
    public string CsrfsState => $"s{Id}";  
    public int    BrowseTime => Id * 5;  
}  
  
public record AuthCode(User User, string Code, string State) {  
    public bool ValidCsrfs(User u) => State == u.CsrfsState;  
    public static AuthCode Create(User u, int seq) {  
        var hash = SHA256.HashData(Encoding.UTF8.GetBytes($"{u.Id}:{seq}"));  
        return new(u, Convert.ToHexString(hash)[..8], u.CsrfsState);  
    }  
}  
  
public record Session(User User, int TokenId);
```

Colour sets are just C# types

Any `notnull, IEquatable<T>` type works — primitives, enums, records, classes.

```
public record User(int Id, string Name) {  
    public string CsrfsState => $"s{Id}";  
    public int    BrowseTime => Id * 5;  
}  
  
public record AuthCode(User User, string Code, string State) {  
    public bool ValidCsrfs(User u) => State == u.CsrfsState;  
    public static AuthCode Create(User u, int seq) {  
        var hash = SHA256.HashData(Encoding.UTF8.GetBytes($"{u.Id}:{seq}"));  
        return new(u, Convert.ToHexString(hash)[..8], u.CsrfsState);  
    }  
}  
  
public record Session(User User, int TokenId);
```

- **Records** — immutable, with value equality

Colour sets are just C# types

Any `notnull, IEquatable<T>` type works — primitives, enums, records, classes.

```
public record User(int Id, string Name) {  
    public string CsrfsState ⇒ $"s{Id}";  
    public int BrowseTime ⇒ Id * 5;  
}  
  
public record AuthCode(User User, string Code, string State) {  
    public bool ValidCsrfs(User u) ⇒ State == u.CsrfsState;  
    public static AuthCode Create(User u, int seq) {  
        var hash = SHA256.HashData(Encoding.UTF8.GetBytes($"u.Id:{seq}"));  
        return new(u, Convert.ToHexString(hash)[..8], u.CsrfsState);  
    }  
}  
  
public record Session(User User, int TokenId);
```

- **Records** — immutable, with value equality
- Methods carry **domain logic** (`CsrfsState` , `BrowseTime`)

Colour sets are just C# types

Any `notnull, IEquatable<T>` type works — primitives, enums, records, classes.

```
public record User(int Id, string Name) {  
    public string CsrfsState => $"s{Id}";  
    public int    BrowseTime => Id * 5;  
}  
  
public record AuthCode(User User, string Code, string State) {  
    public bool ValidCsrfs(User u) => State == u.CsrfsState;  
    public static AuthCode Create(User u, int seq) {  
        var hash = SHA256.HashData(Encoding.UTF8.GetBytes($"{u.Id}:{seq}"));  
        return new(u, Convert.ToHexString(hash)[..8], u.CsrfsState);  
    }  
}  
  
public record Session(User User, int TokenId);
```

- **Records** — immutable, with value equality
- Methods carry **domain logic** (`CsrfsState` , `BrowseTime`)
- The **CSRF check** is part of the colour set

Colour sets are just C# types

Any `notnull`, `IEquatable<T>` type works — primitives, enums, records, classes.

```
public record User(int Id, string Name) {  
    public string CsrfsState => $"s{Id}";  
    public int    BrowseTime => Id * 5;  
}  
  
public record AuthCode(User User, string Code, string State) {  
    public bool ValidCsrfs(User u) => State == u.CsrfsState;  
    public static AuthCode Create(User u, int seq) {  
        var hash = SHA256.HashData(Encoding.UTF8.GetBytes($"u.Id:{seq}"));  
        return new(u, Convert.ToHexString(hash)[..8], u.CsrfsState);  
    }  
}  
  
public record Session(User User, int TokenId);
```

- **Records** — immutable, with value equality
- Methods carry **domain logic** (`CsrfsState` , `BrowseTime`)
- The **CSRF check** is part of the colour set
- Real cryptography (`SHA256`) inside the model

Colour sets are just C# types

Any `notnull, IEquatable<T>` type works — primitives, enums, records, classes.

```
public record User(int Id, string Name) {
    public string CsrfsState => $"s{Id}";
    public int    BrowseTime => Id * 5;
}

public record AuthCode(User User, string Code, string State) {
    public bool ValidCsrfs(User u) => State == u.CsrfsState;
    public static AuthCode Create(User u, int seq) {
        var hash = SHA256.HashData(Encoding.UTF8.GetBytes($"u.Id:{seq}"));
        return new(u, Convert.ToHexString(hash)[..8], u.CsrfsState);
    }
}

public record Session(User User, int TokenId);
```

- **Records** — immutable, with value equality
- Methods carry **domain logic** (`CsrfsState` , `BrowseTime`)
- The **CSRF check** is part of the colour set
- Real cryptography (`SHA256`) inside the model

Places & multisets

```
// inside the model constructor
var authReq = AddPlace<AuthCode>("AuthReq");           // empty initial marking

var idle    = AddPlace("Idle", Multiset.Of(
    new User(1, "Alice"), new User(2, "Bob"), new User(3, "Carol")));

var exchg   = AddTimedPlace<AuthCode>("Exchanging");    // timed place
```


Places & multisets

```
// inside the model constructor
var authReq = AddPlace<AuthCode>("AuthReq");           // empty initial marking

var idle     = AddPlace("Idle", Multiset.Of(
    new User(1,"Alice"), new User(2,"Bob"), new User(3,"Carol")));

var exchg    = AddTimedPlace<AuthCode>("Exchanging");  // timed place
```

- `Place<T>` — the type parameter (T) specifies the colour set

Places & multisets

```
// inside the model constructor
var authReq = AddPlace<AuthCode>("AuthReq");           // empty initial marking

var idle    = AddPlace("Idle", Multiset.Of(
    new User(1,"Alice"), new User(2,"Bob"), new User(3,"Carol")));

var exchg   = AddTimedPlace<AuthCode>("Exchanging");    // timed place
```

- `Place<T>` — the type parameter (T) specifies the colour set
- `Multiset<T>` — immutable, strongly typed bag

Places & multisets

```
// inside the model constructor
var authReq = AddPlace<AuthCode>("AuthReq");           // empty initial marking

var idle    = AddPlace("Idle", Multiset.Of(
    new User(1,"Alice"), new User(2,"Bob"), new User(3,"Carol")));

var exchg   = AddTimedPlace<AuthCode>("Exchanging");    // timed place
```

- `Place<T>` — the type parameter (T) specifies the colour set
- `Multiset<T>` — immutable, strongly typed bag
- `AddTimedPlace<T>` → place of `Timed<T>` tokens

Places & multisets

```
// inside the model constructor
var authReq = AddPlace<AuthCode>("AuthReq");           // empty initial marking

var idle    = AddPlace("Idle", Multiset.Of(
    new User(1, "Alice"), new User(2, "Bob"), new User(3, "Carol")));

var exchg    = AddTimedPlace<AuthCode>("Exchanging");    // timed place
```

- `Place<T>` — the type parameter (T) specifies the colour set
- `Multiset<T>` — immutable, strongly typed bag
- `AddTimedPlace<T>` → place of `Timed<T>` tokens

Transitions: a fluent builder

```
var u = new Var<User>("u");

AddTransition("Login")
    .Input(idle, u).Output(waiting, u)
    .Output(authReq, () => AuthCode.Create(u.Val), "AuthReq")
    .Build();

AddTransition("ReceiveCode")
    .Input(authResp, c).Input(waiting, u)
    .Guard(() => c.Val.ValidCsrft(u.Val))
    .TimedOutput(exchg, () => c.Val, Config.ExchangeTime)
    .Build();
```

Transitions: a fluent builder

```
var u = new Var<User>("u");

AddTransition("Login")
    .Input(idle, u).Output(waiting, u)
    .Output(authReq, () => AuthCode.Create(u.Val), "AuthReq")
    .Build();

AddTransition("ReceiveCode")
    .Input(authResp, c).Input(waiting, u)
    .Guard(() => c.Val.ValidCsrft(u.Val))
    .TimedOutput(exchg, () => c.Val, Config.ExchangeTime)
    .Build();
```

- Variables are strongly typed

Transitions: a fluent builder

```
var u = new Var<User>("u");

AddTransition("Login")
    .Input(idle, u).Output(waiting, u)
    .Output(authReq, () => AuthCode.Create(u.Val), "AuthReq")
    .Build();

AddTransition("ReceiveCode")
    .Input(authResp, c).Input(waiting, u)
    .Guard(() => c.Val.ValidCsrft(u.Val))
    .TimedOutput(exchg, () => c.Val, Config.ExchangeTime)
    .Build();
```

- Variables are strongly typed
- Transitions are build fluently

Transitions: a fluent builder

```
var u = new Var<User>("u");

AddTransition("Login")
    .Input(idle, u).Output(waiting, u)
    .Output(authReq, () => AuthCode.Create(u.Val), "AuthReq")
    .Build();

AddTransition("ReceiveCode")
    .Input(authResp, c).Input(waiting, u)
    .Guard(() => c.Val.ValidCsrft(u.Val))
    .TimedOutput(exchg, () => c.Val, Config.ExchangeTime)
    .Build();
```

- Variables are strongly typed
- Transitions are build fluently
- Arcs are built to and from transitions

Transitions: a fluent builder

```
var u = new Var<User>("u");

AddTransition("Login")
    .Input(idle, u).Output(waiting, u)
    .Output(authReq, () => AuthCode.Create(u.Val), "AuthReq")
    .Build();

AddTransition("ReceiveCode")
    .Input(authResp, c).Input(waiting, u)
    .Guard(() => c.Val.ValidCsrft(u.Val))
    .TimedOutput(exchg, () => c.Val, Config.ExchangeTime)
    .Build();
```

- Variables are strongly typed
- Transitions are build fluently
- Arcs are built to and from transitions
- Output arc expressions **C# lambdas** (or just a variable)

Transitions: a fluent builder

```
var u = new Var<User>("u");

AddTransition("Login")
    .Input(idle, u).Output(waiting, u)
    .Output(authReq, () => AuthCode.Create(u.Val), "AuthReq")
    .Build();

AddTransition("ReceiveCode")
    .Input(authResp, c).Input(waiting, u)
    .Guard(() => c.Val.ValidCsrft(u.Val))
    .TimedOutput(exchg, () => c.Val, Config.ExchangeTime)
    .Build();
```

- Variables are strongly typed
- Transitions are build fluently
- Arcs are built to and from transitions
- Output arc expressions **C# lambdas** (or just a variable)
- Guards are **C# lambdas** — compiler-checked

Transitions: a fluent builder

```
var u = new Var<User>("u");

AddTransition("Login")
    .Input(idle, u).Output(waiting, u)
    .Output(authReq, () => AuthCode.Create(u.Val), "AuthReq")
    .Build();

AddTransition("ReceiveCode")
    .Input(authResp, c).Input(waiting, u)
    .Guard(() => c.Val.ValidCsrft(u.Val))
    .TimedOutput(exchg, () => c.Val, Config.ExchangeTime)
    .Build();
```

- Variables are strongly typed
- Transitions are build fluently
- Arcs are built to and from transitions
- Output arc expressions **C# lambdas** (or just a variable)
- Guards are **C# lambdas** — compiler-checked

Timed CPNs

```
AddTransition("GrantToken")
    .TimedInput(exchg, c).Input(nextTokId, tid)
    .Output(nextTokId, () => tid.Val + 1)
    .Output(loggedIn, () => new Session(c.Val.User, tid.Val))
    .TimedOutput(expiry, () => new Session(c.Val.User, tid.Val), Config.SessionTTL)
    .TimedOutput(browsing, () => new Session(c.Val.User, tid.Val),
        () => c.Val.User.BrowseTime)

    .Build();

AddTransition("SessionExpire")
    .TimedInput(expiry, se).Input(loggedIn, se2)
    .Guard(() => se.Val.TokenId == se2.Val.TokenId)
    .Output(idle, () => se.Val.User)
    .Build();
```

Timed CPNs

```
AddTransition("GrantToken")
    .TimedInput(exchg, c).Input(nextTokId, tid)
    .Output(nextTokId, () => tid.Val + 1)
    .Output(loggedIn, () => new Session(c.Val.User, tid.Val))
    .TimedOutput(expiry, () => new Session(c.Val.User, tid.Val), Config.SessionTTL)
    .TimedOutput(browsing, () => new Session(c.Val.User, tid.Val),
        () => c.Val.User.BrowseTime)

    .Build();

AddTransition("SessionExpire")
    .TimedInput(expiry, se).Input(loggedIn, se2)
    .Guard(() => se.Val.TokenId == se2.Val.TokenId)
    .Output(idle, () => se.Val.User)
    .Build();
```

- Global integer clock; `Timed<T>` tokens carry timestamps

Timed CPNs

```
AddTransition("GrantToken")
    .TimedInput(exchg, c).Input(nextTokId, tid)
    .Output(nextTokId, () => tid.Val + 1)
    .Output(loggedIn, () => new Session(c.Val.User, tid.Val))
    .TimedOutput(expiry, () => new Session(c.Val.User, tid.Val), Config.SessionTTL)
    .TimedOutput(browsing, () => new Session(c.Val.User, tid.Val),
        () => c.Val.User.BrowseTime)

    .Build();

AddTransition("SessionExpire")
    .TimedInput(expiry, se).Input(loggedIn, se2)
    .Guard(() => se.Val.TokenId == se2.Val.TokenId)
    .Output(idle, () => se.Val.User)
    .Build();
```

- Global integer clock; `Timed<T>` tokens carry timestamps
- One transition fires **three** outputs — session, expiry, browse-timer

Timed CPNs

```
AddTransition("GrantToken")
    .TimedInput(exchg, c).Input(nextTokId, tid)
    .Output(nextTokId, () => tid.Val + 1)
    .Output(loggedIn, () => new Session(c.Val.User, tid.Val))
    .TimedOutput(expiry, () => new Session(c.Val.User, tid.Val), Config.SessionTTL)
    .TimedOutput(browsing, () => new Session(c.Val.User, tid.Val),
        () => c.Val.User.BrowseTime)

    .Build();

AddTransition("SessionExpire")
    .TimedInput(expiry, se).Input(loggedIn, se2)
    .Guard(() => se.Val.TokenId == se2.Val.TokenId)
    .Output(idle, () => se.Val.User)
    .Build();
```

- Global integer clock; `Timed<T>` tokens carry timestamps
- One transition fires **three** outputs — session, expiry, browse-timer
- `SessionExpire` consumes the expiry timer when it matures — races with `Logout` (in `UserPage`) for the same session

Timed CPNs

```
AddTransition("GrantToken")
    .TimedInput(exchg, c).Input(nextTokId, tid)
    .Output(nextTokId, () => tid.Val + 1)
    .Output(loggedIn, () => new Session(c.Val.User, tid.Val))
    .TimedOutput(expiry, () => new Session(c.Val.User, tid.Val), Config.SessionTTL)
    .TimedOutput(browsing, () => new Session(c.Val.User, tid.Val),
        () => c.Val.User.BrowseTime)

    .Build();

AddTransition("SessionExpire")
    .TimedInput(expiry, se).Input(loggedIn, se2)
    .Guard(() => se.Val.TokenId == se2.Val.TokenId)
    .Output(idle, () => se.Val.User)
    .Build();
```

- Global integer clock; `Timed<T>` tokens carry timestamps
- One transition fires **three** outputs — session, expiry, browse-timer
- `SessionExpire` consumes the expiry timer when it matures — races with `Logout` (in `UserPage`) for the same session

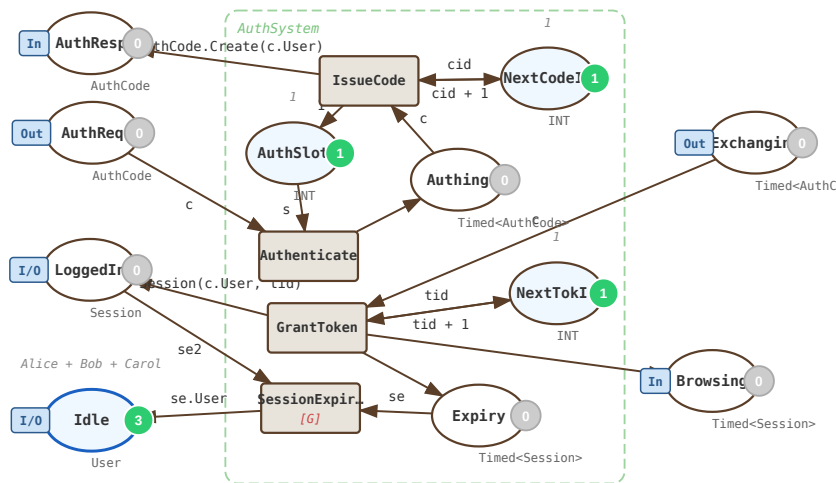
Hierarchical CPNs

```

class UserPage : CpnPage {
    public UserPage(Place<User> idle,
        Place<AuthCode> authReq, ...)
        : base("User") {
        InOut(idle);
        Out(authReq); In(authResp);
        Out(exchg);
        InOut(loggedIn); In(browsing);
        var waiting = AddPlace<User>("Waiting");
        // Login, ReceiveCode, Logout
    }
}

// assembly
AddSubPage(new UserPage(...), "User");
AddSubPage(new AuthSystemPage(...), "AuthSystem");

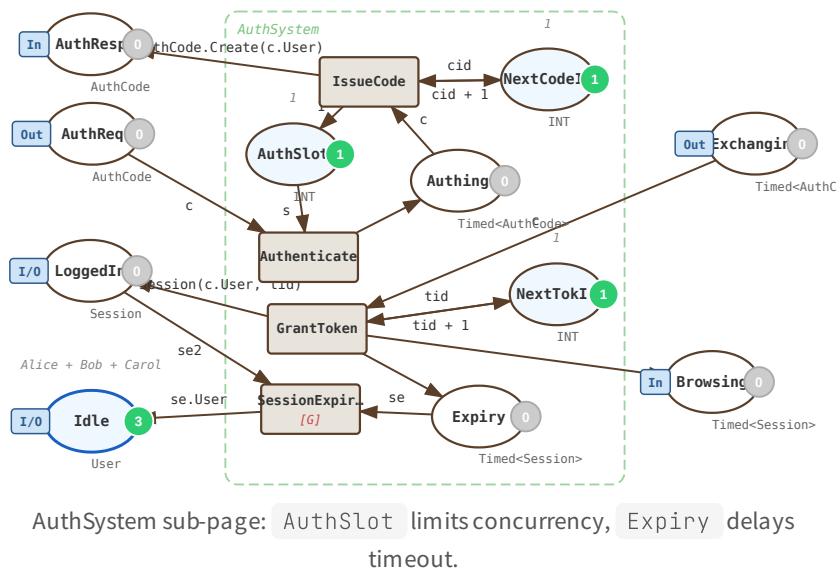
```



AuthSystem sub-page: AuthSlot limits concurrency, Expiry delays timeout.

Hierarchical CPNs

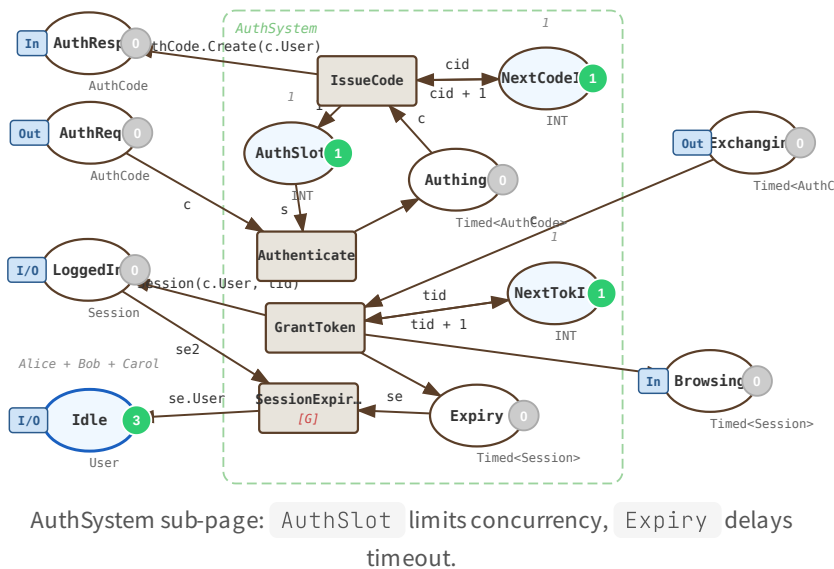
```
class UserPage : CpnPage {
    public UserPage(Place<User> idle,
        Place<AuthCode> authReq, ...)
        : base("User") {
        InOut(idle);
        Out(authReq); In(authResp);
        Out(exchg);
        InOut(loggedIn); In(browsing);
        var waiting = AddPlace<User>("Waiting");
        // Login, ReceiveCode, Logout
    }
}
// assembly
AddSubPage(new UserPage(...), "User");
AddSubPage(new AuthSystemPage(...), "AuthSystem");
```



- A sub-page is a `CpnPage` subclass

Hierarchical CPNs

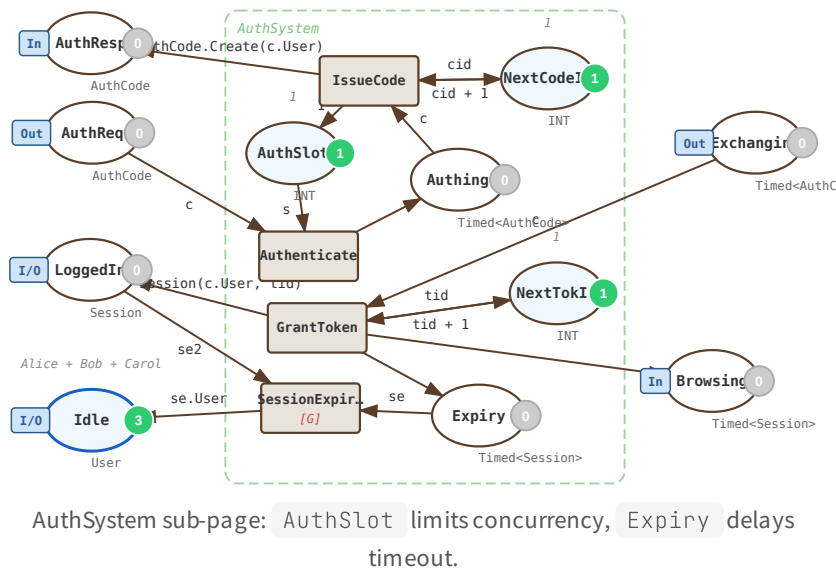
```
class UserPage : CpnPage {
    public UserPage(Place<User> idle,
        Place<AuthCode> authReq, ...)
        : base("User") {
        InOut(idle);
        Out(authReq); In(authResp);
        Out(exchg);
        InOut(loggedIn); In(browsing);
        var waiting = AddPlace<User>("Waiting");
        // Login, ReceiveCode, Logout
    }
}
// assembly
AddSubPage(new UserPage(...), "User");
AddSubPage(new AuthSystemPage(...), "AuthSystem");
```



- A sub-page is a CpnPage **subclass**
- Ports use In() / Out() / InOut() — CPN Tools style

Hierarchical CPNs

```
class UserPage : CpnPage {
    public UserPage(Place<User> idle,
        Place<AuthCode> authReq, ...)
        : base("User") {
        InOut(idle);
        Out(authReq); In(authResp);
        Out(exchg);
        InOut(loggedIn); In(browsing);
        var waiting = AddPlace<User>("Waiting");
        // Login, ReceiveCode, Logout
    }
}
// assembly
AddSubPage(new UserPage(...), "User");
AddSubPage(new AuthSystemPage(...), "AuthSystem");
```

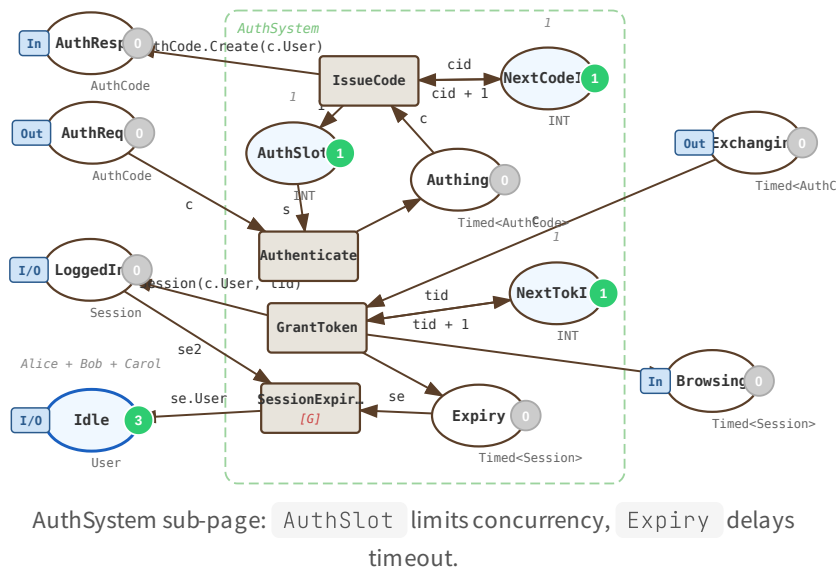


AuthSystem sub-page: AuthSlot limits concurrency, Expiry delays timeout.

- A sub-page is a CpnPage subclass
- Ports use In() / Out() / InOut() — CPN Tools style
- AddSubPage wires it into the parent

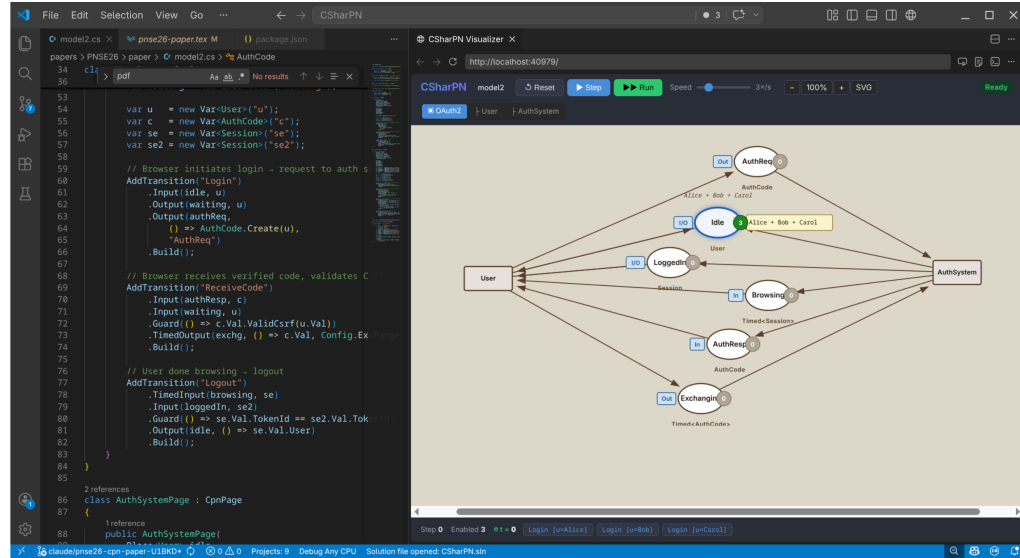
Hierarchical CPNs

```
class UserPage : CpnPage {  
    public UserPage(Place<User> idle,  
        Place<AuthCode> authReq, ...)  
        : base("User") {  
        InOut(idle);  
        Out(authReq); In(authResp);  
        Out(exchg);  
        InOut(loggedIn); In(browsing);  
        var waiting = AddPlace<User>("Waiting");  
        // Login, ReceiveCode, Logout  
    }  
}  
// assembly  
AddSubPage(new UserPage(...), "User");  
AddSubPage(new AuthSystemPage(...), "AuthSystem");
```



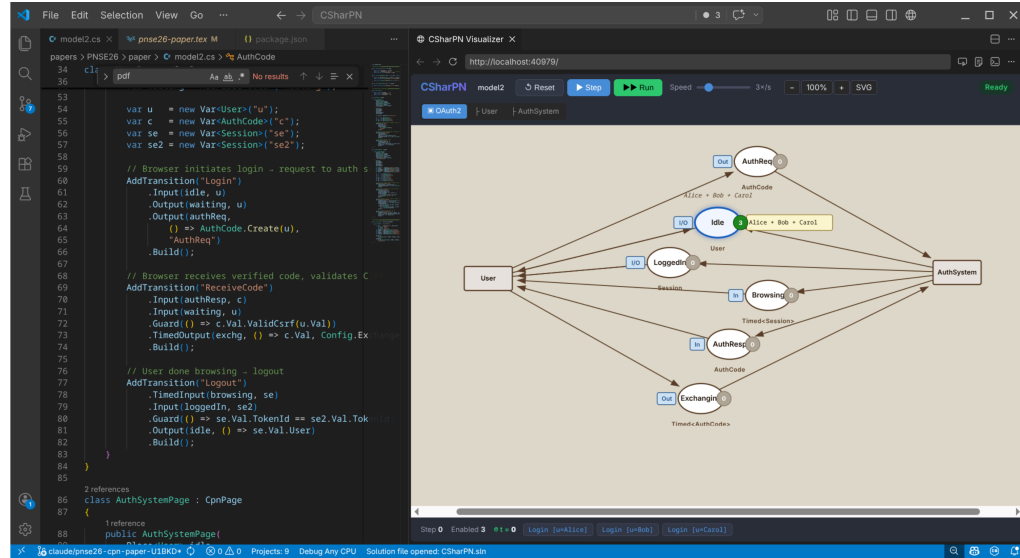
- A sub-page is a CpnPage subclass
- Ports use In() / Out() / InOut() — CPN Tools style
- AddSubPage wires it into the parent

Visualiser & VS Code integration



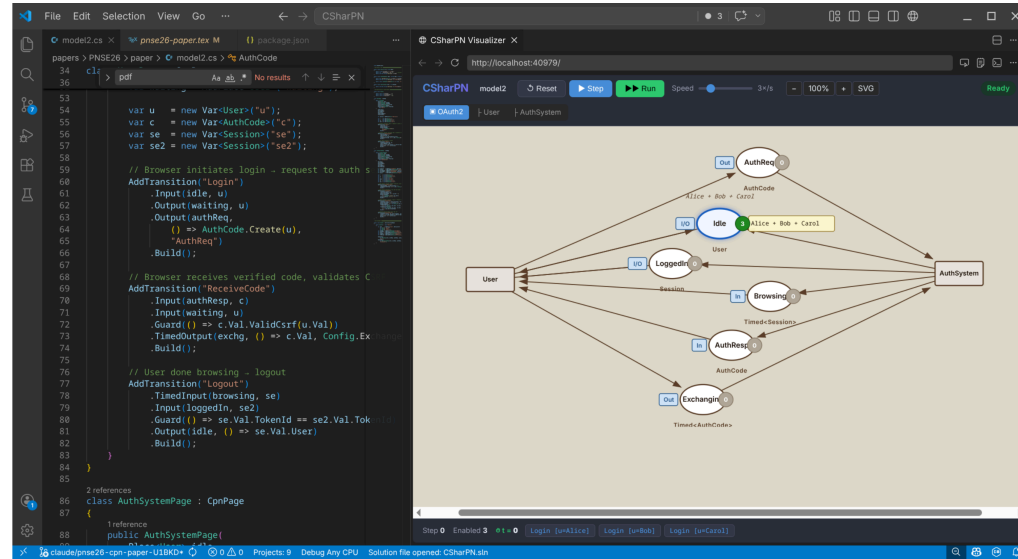
Visualiser & VS Code integration

- Blazor app in VS Code's Simple Browser panel



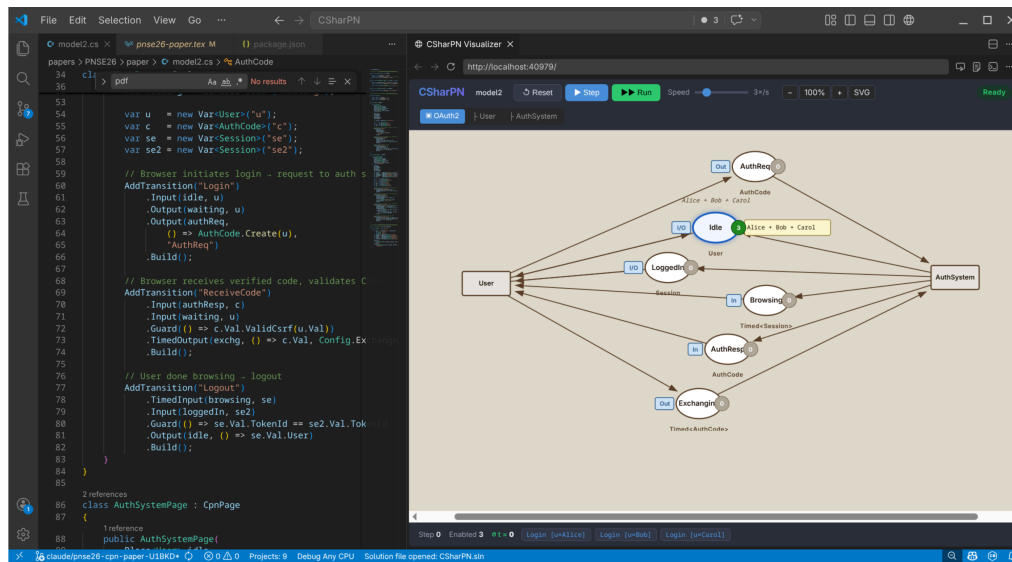
Visualiser & VS Code integration

- Blazor app in VS Code's Simple Browser panel
- Page tree — drill into sub-pages



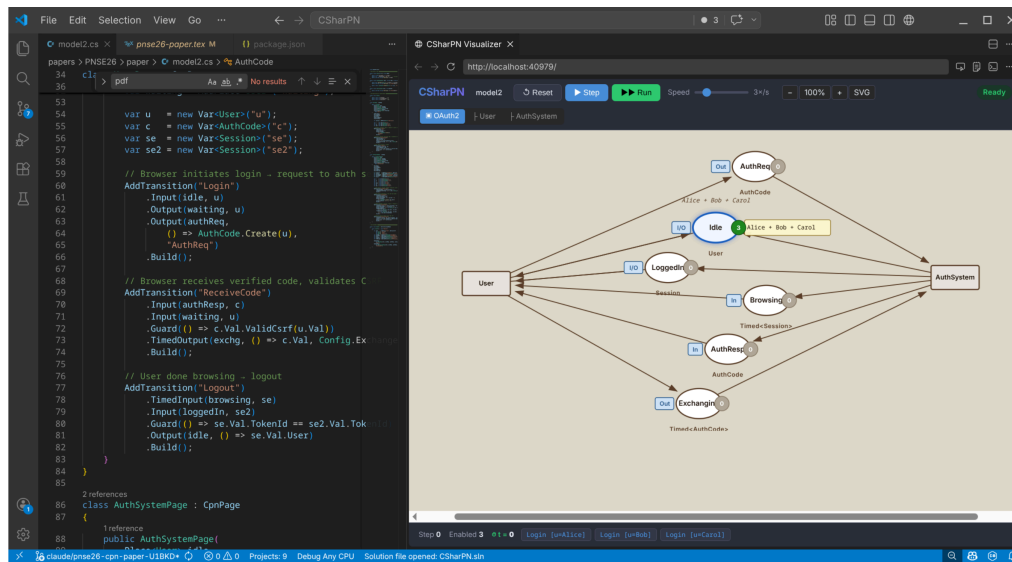
Visualiser & VS Code integration

- Blazor app in VS Code's Simple Browser panel
- Page tree — drill into sub-pages
- Clock, step count, enabled bindings



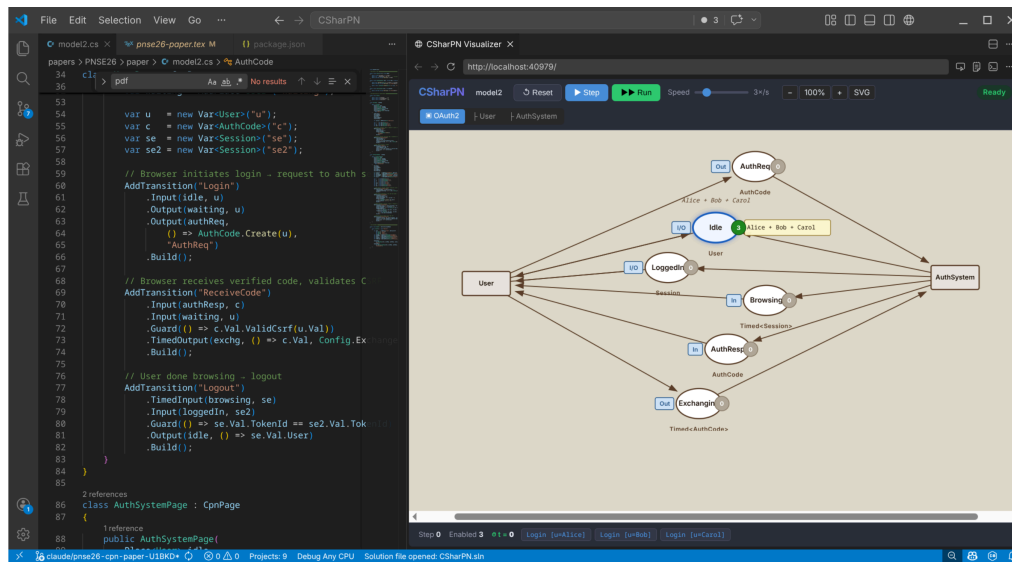
Visualiser & VS Code integration

- Blazor app in VS Code's Simple Browser panel
- Page tree — drill into sub-pages
- Clock, step count, enabled bindings
- Click a binding to fire it



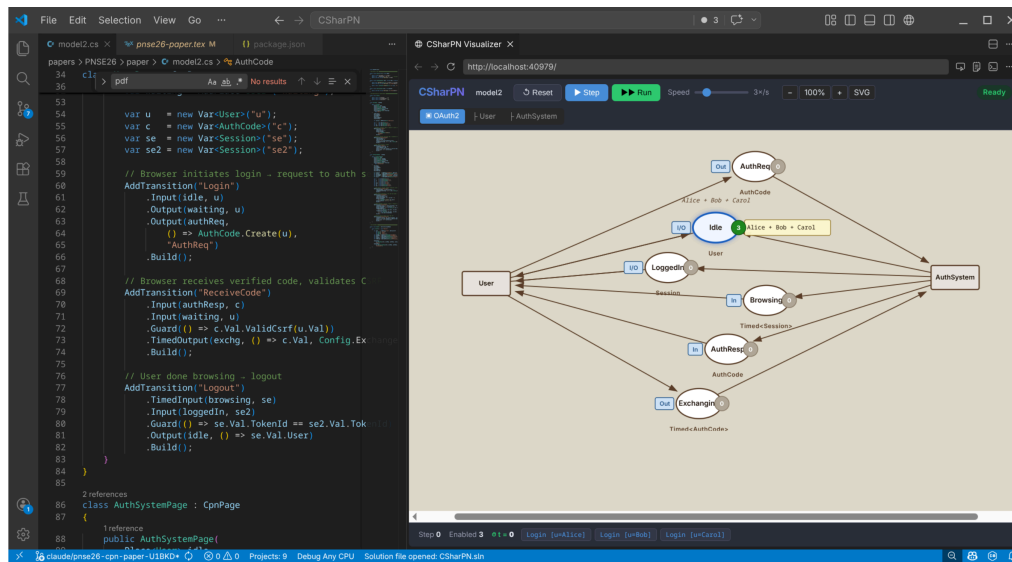
Visualiser & VS Code integration

- Blazor app in VS Code's Simple Browser panel
- Page tree — drill into sub-pages
- Clock, step count, enabled bindings
- Click a binding to fire it
- **Double-click** a place/transition → jump to source line



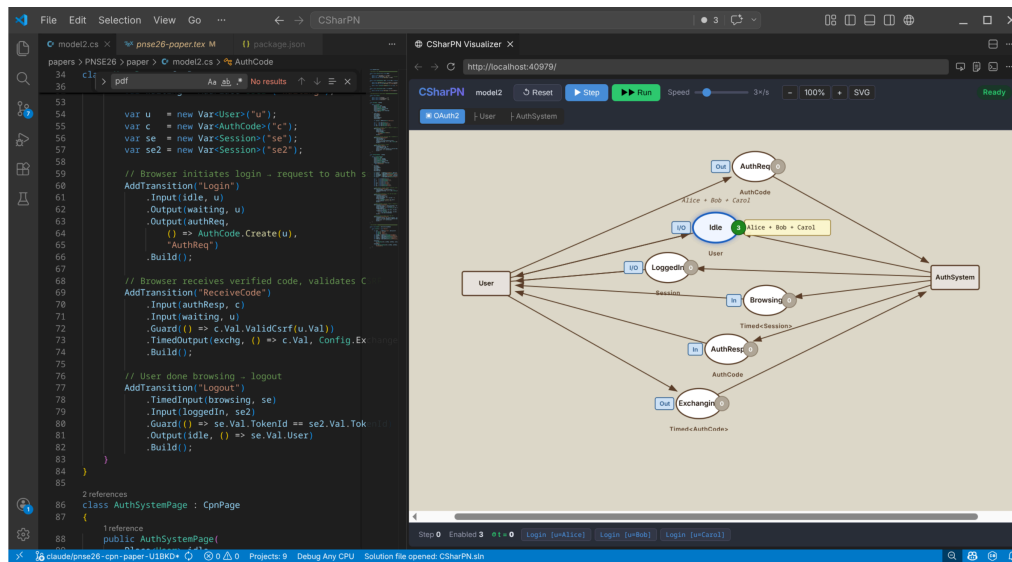
Visualiser & VS Code integration

- Blazor app in VS Code's Simple Browser panel
- Page tree — drill into sub-pages
- Clock, step count, enabled bindings
- Click a binding to fire it
- **Double-click** a place/transition → jump to source line
- Layout persisted in `model.cs.layout`



Visualiser & VS Code integration

- Blazor app in VS Code's Simple Browser panel
- Page tree — drill into sub-pages
- Clock, step count, enabled bindings
- Click a binding to fire it
- **Double-click** a place/transition → jump to source line
- Layout persisted in `model.cs.layout`
- **Hot reload**: save .cs → recompile → reload, marking preserved



Models as programs

key insight

When the inscription language is the host language, the model *is* the program.

Models as programs

key insight

When the inscription language is the host language, the model *is* the program.

- **Version control** — plain `.cs` files, real diffs, real PRs

Models as programs

key insight

When the inscription language is the host language, the model *is* the program.

- **Version control** — plain `.cs` files, real diffs, real PRs
- **Refactoring & IntelliSense** — rename a colour set across the model

Models as programs

key insight

When the inscription language is the host language, the model *is* the program.

- **Version control** — plain `.cs` files, real diffs, real PRs
- **Refactoring & IntelliSense** — rename a colour set across the model
- **Unit tests** — xUnit/NUit asserts on markings

Models as programs

key insight

When the inscription language is the host language, the model *is* the program.

- **Version control** — plain `.cs` files, real diffs, real PRs
- **Refactoring & IntelliSense** — rename a colour set across the model
- **Unit tests** — xUnit/NUit asserts on markings
- **Domain libraries** — real crypto, real currency conversion, in your model

Models as programs

key insight

When the inscription language is the host language, the model *is* the program.

- **Version control** — plain `.cs` files, real diffs, real PRs
- **Refactoring & IntelliSense** — rename a colour set across the model
- **Unit tests** — xUnit/NUit asserts on markings
- **Domain libraries** — real crypto, real currency conversion, in your model
- **Composition with production code** — ship the model as a NuGet package

Models as programs

key insight

When the inscription language is the host language, the model *is* the program.

- **Version control** — plain `.cs` files, real diffs, real PRs
- **Refactoring & IntelliSense** — rename a colour set across the model
- **Unit tests** — xUnit/NUit asserts on markings
- **Domain libraries** — real crypto, real currency conversion, in your model
- **Composition with production code** — ship the model as a NuGet package

No code-generation step. No generated artefact, no model/implementation sync problem — the gap is zero by construction. (Caveat:

only when the deployment target is .NET.)

Future work

- Models as deployable .NET components (HTTP-driven transitions/places)

Future work

- Models as deployable .NET components (HTTP-driven transitions/places)
 - CPN-as-test-harness for existing C# libraries
 - State-space analysis on CpnState snapshots
 - Empirical evaluation: usability study + simulator performance vs CPN Tools

Future work

- Models as deployable .NET components (HTTP-driven transitions/places)
 - CPN-as-test-harness for existing C# libraries
 - State-space analysis on `CpnState` snapshots
 - Empirical evaluation: usability study + simulator performance vs CPN Tools

Takeaway: when the inscription language is C#, the full power of a mature programming language — type system, libraries, tooling — is available to the CPN modeller at no extra cost.

Thank you

Questions?



CSharpN — MIT licensed

`github.com/simontjell/CSharpN.public`

Simon Tjell · `simon@simplesystemer.dk`